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Advisory Announcement
For Immediate Release: **August 18, 2026**

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Norton Sound Advisory Announcement #18
COMMERCIAL FISHING TO OPEN IN NORTON SOUND SUBDISTRICTS 2-6

Emergency Order: 3-S-Z-11-26

Commercial salmon gillnet fishing will open for one 24-hour period in Norton Sound Subdistricts 2–6, the Golovin, Elim, Norton Bay, Shaktoolik, and Unalakleet Subdistricts.

- **Golovin Subdistrict 2**
  - will open to commercial salmon fishing for one 24-hour period:
    - from 6:00 p.m. Thursday, August 20, until 6:00 p.m. Friday, August 21.

- **Elim Subdistrict 3**
  - will open to commercial salmon fishing for one 24-hour period:
    - from 6:00 p.m. Thursday, August 20, until 6:00 p.m. Friday, August 21.

- **Norton Bay Subdistrict 4**
  - will open to commercial salmon fishing for one 24-hour period:
    - from 6:00 p.m. Thursday, August 20, until 6:00 p.m. Friday, August 21.

- **Shaktoolik Subdistrict 5**
  - will open to commercial salmon fishing for one 24-hour period:
    - from 6:00 p.m. Thursday, August 20, until 6:00 p.m. Friday, August 21.

- **Unalakleet Subdistrict 6**:
  - will open to commercial salmon fishing for one 24-hour period:
    - from 6:00 p.m. Thursday, August 20, until 6:00 p.m. Friday, August 21.

All commercial fishing periods are directed to target chum and coho salmon with gillnet mesh size restricted to 6 inches or smaller.

The previous commercial periods in Subdistricts 2–6 had slightly below average catch rates and salmon monitoring projects in the region are generally inoperable. Kwiniuk River tower is the exception and is operationally and coho salmon in this system is projected to meet the escapement goal and provide for subsistence needs with a harvestable surplus available for commercial fishing. This commercial period will continue to gauge coho salmon abundance in marine waters and maybe used to justify additional commercial periods targeting coho salmon.

Permit holders are reminded to ensure they have a market for their catch. This commercial fishing period does not affect current subsistence fisheries schedules, restrictions, or closures.

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